

Stripe Field Guide

Stripe fails quietly. A webhook endpoint stops delivering and the payments still succeed, so revenue looks normal while everything that should happen after a payment stops. Every script here is read only.

13 fixes, each one a written note with diagrams and a small Python and Node.js script that finds the problem and repairs it. All 13 have a script in the public repo.

Before you run anything. Every script starts in a dry run: it reports what it would change and writes nothing. Read that output first, then set `DRY_RUN=false` when you are satisfied it has understood your data.

Scripts: github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes

Guides: allanninal.dev/stripe

All 14 repos: github.com/allanninal

The fixes

1 3DS handoff breaks and requires_action intents pile up

Card volume from Europe and India reads lower than your traffic says it should. Nothing fails. There are no declines to look at, no errors in the logs, and no support tickets, because from the customer's side the page simply did nothing. The intents stopped at `requires_action` and stayed there.

[stripe_requires_action.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/abandoned-requires-action-intents/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/abandoned-requires-action-intents>

2 two endpoints share one URL, so every event is handled twice

Two order rows for one payment. Two fulfilment emails. A customer credited twice. The handler reads correctly, it passes its tests, and it does not misbehave locally — because locally there is one endpoint, and in production there are two pointing at the same URL.

[stripe_duplicate_endpoints.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/duplicate-endpoints-same-url/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/duplicate-endpoints-same-url>

3 **payout.failed is unsubscribed so failures go unseen for days**

Money stopped arriving in the bank account. Nothing alerted, nothing errored, and the balance in Stripe kept climbing. On a Connect platform it is worse: the sellers notice before the platform does, and they notice by not being paid.

[stripe_payout_events.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/missing-payout-failed/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/missing-payout-failed>

4 **past_due subscriptions keep their access forever**

Renewals have been failing for months and nobody noticed, because the customers are still logged in and still using the product. The entitlement check in your app asks whether the subscription is canceled. It is not canceled. It is past_due, which the check has never heard of, so the answer is yes, let them in.

[stripe_past_due_subs.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/past-due-subscriptions-accumulating/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/past-due-subscriptions-accumulating>

5 **radar blocks payments and nobody reads the block reasons**

Support keeps hearing the same sentence: my card works everywhere else. The charge shows as failed with a message that says nothing, the customer's bank has no record of the attempt at all, and nobody on your side can say why. The payment never left Stripe.

[stripe_radar_blocks.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/radar-blocked-payments-ignored/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/radar-blocked-payments-ignored>

6 **refunds sit failed or requires_action and nobody notices**

Support issued the refund, the ticket was closed, and the money left your Stripe balance. Weeks later the same customer opens a dispute for the same transaction, because it never arrived. You now pay the amount twice and the dispute fee on top, and the only record of what went wrong was a status change on an object nobody was watching.

[stripe_refund_health.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/refunds-failed-or-stuck/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/refunds-failed-or-stuck>

7 **paymentIntents sit in requires_payment_method for weeks**

The Payments page shows a long tail of incomplete payments that never resolve into anything. Checkout starts and successful payments have drifted apart by a factor nobody can explain, and the gap grows every week. Most of those intents were never going to succeed: they were created before the customer had done anything, and nothing ever went back to them.

[stripe_stale_intents.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/stale-requires-payment-method-intents/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/stale-requires-payment-method-intents>

8 active subscriptions with nothing to charge on renewal

The subscription says active. The customer has access, the MRR chart counts them, and the renewal date is in the calendar. Then the renewal date arrives and the invoice fails, and it fails again next month, and Stripe never retries any of it — because there is nothing to retry against.

[stripe_sub_payment_method.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/subscription-without-payment-method/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/subscription-without-payment-method>

9 incomplete subscriptions die silently after 23 hours

Someone filled in the card form, saw a spinner, and closed the tab believing they had subscribed. Stripe has a subscription for them in incomplete. In under a day that record becomes `incomplete_expired`, the open invoice is voided, and there is nothing left to recover — no charge, no error, no ticket.

[stripe_incomplete_subs.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/subscriptions-stuck-incomplete/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/subscriptions-stuck-incomplete>

10 trials ending in days with no card on file

Card-free trials are good for signups and they build a queue. Everyone who started a trial on the first of the month reaches its end on the same day, and the ones without a card all fail together. What happens next is one Stripe setting most teams have never opened, and its default is the loudest of the three options and the quietest to you.

[stripe_trial_no_card.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/trial-ends-without-payment-method/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/trial-ends-without-payment-method>

11 undelivered events are aging out of the 30-day window

The handler is fixed. The endpoint is enabled again. Now someone has to replay three weeks of missed events, and a quiet arithmetic problem is waiting: Stripe keeps events for 30 days, the oldest ones are on day 26, and the backfill script has not been written yet.

[stripe_event_retention.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/undelivered-events-nearing-retention/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/undelivered-events-nearing-retention>

12 a webhook endpoint sits disabled after days of retries

Orders stopped being fulfilled on a Tuesday. Nothing changed in your code that week, nothing appears in your application logs, and Stripe still shows the payments as succeeded. Nothing is arriving at all — Stripe gave up on the endpoint and stopped trying.

[stripe_webhook_health.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/webhook-endpoint-disabled/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/webhook-endpoint-disabled>

13 **an endpoint subscribes to every event and floods the handler**

The webhook route is slow, and it is slow at the worst possible time: the end of the month, when renewals run. It handles four event types. It is being sent everything Stripe generates, and the other ninety-odd types still cost a request, a signature verification, and a database round trip before the handler decides it does not care.

[stripe_wildcard_events.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/stripe/wildcard-enabled-events/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/stripe-fixes/tree/main/wildcard-enabled-events>
